```
  "speed_mph":186
}
```

Because this is the first document to be stored in the `cars` index, when we send this request to Elasticsearch, the server instantly creates an index called `cars` because that index doesn't exist in the store. The index is configured with the default settings and a document ID of 1. We can fetch the details of the newly created index by invoking the `GET cars` command, as figure 6.1 shows.

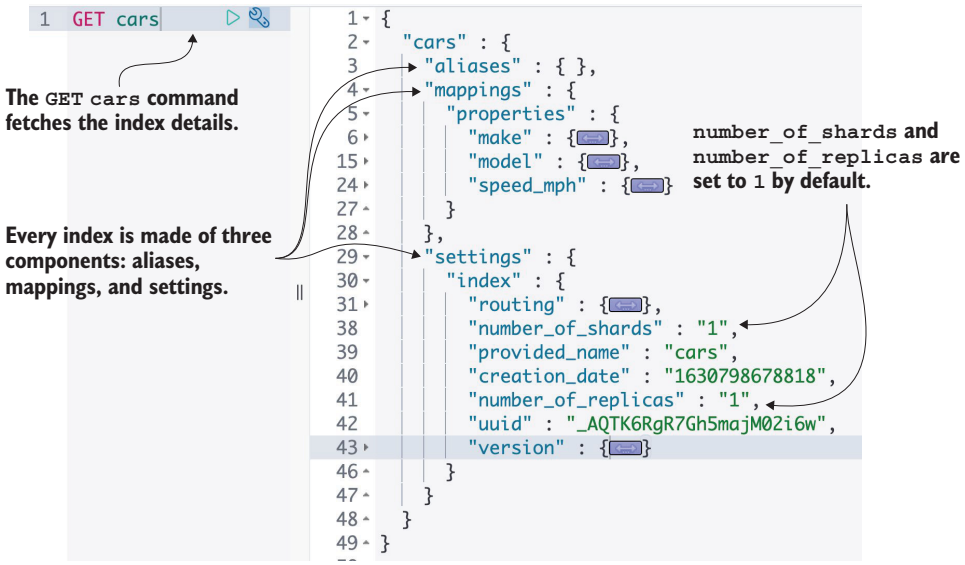


Figure 6.1 Fetching the details of the `cars` index

We should note a few important things from the response: each index is made of *mappings*, *settings*, and *aliases*. Elasticsearch creates the mappings schema automatically by determining each field's data type from the field's value. For example, because the `make` and `model` types seem to contain textual information, these fields are created as `text` fields. Also, Elasticsearch takes the liberty of allocating a primary shard and a replica shard by default.

Static settings can't be changed on an operational index

Not all default settings (`number_of_shards`, `number_of_replicas`, etc.) applied by the engine can be changed on an index that's operational. For example, the `number_of_replicas` setting can be modified on a live index, but `number_of_shards` can't. We need to take that shard offline to change the primary shard's number and other static settings.